

# The Onboarding Questionnaire

*What new users are asked when they set up the app, and what the app does with the answers.*

*Version 2, prepared for review on 17 September 2026.*

## In short

When someone first uses the app, it asks a short set of questions: what foods they must avoid, what happens when they eat them, how serious it has been, and whether any health condition affects their diet.

Every product scanned afterwards is checked against those answers. That makes this the most important screen in the app after the scan result itself: a wrong or missing answer here means a wrong warning later.

## What changed in version 2

**One person per Free account.** The Free plan covers the account holder only. Adding family members is part of the paid plans (Plus and Family), so the questionnaire only offers it on those plans.

**People can add their own foods.** If something they must avoid isn't in our list, they can type it in. It is checked on labels straight away.

## 1. How it works

- **One person at a time.** The user answers for themselves. On Plus or Family, they can then add a child, partner or anyone else they shop for, and answer for them.
- **People per plan.** Free covers one person, Plus five, Family fifteen. Our team can change these numbers at any time without an app update.
- **About 12 questions per person,** fewer if they have no allergies. Some questions only appear when an earlier answer makes them relevant.
- **Before or after sign-up.** The questions can be shown before the person creates an account, and saved once they have.
- **The answers become the person's profile:** a list of foods to avoid (each with how serious it is), any health conditions, and personal notes.
- **Everything is kept.** The original answers are stored alongside the profile, so it is always possible to see why something was recorded the way it was.
- **It can be updated.** Going through the questions again adds to or updates the profile. It never deletes anything (see section 4).

## 2. The questions

Wherever a question says **[name]**, the app uses the person's name, or "you" for the account holder.

### Part 1: Who is this for?

#### Question 1. Who are you setting up?

*Always asked.*

| Answer                                                 | Offered on                           | What happens                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Me                                                     | Every plan                           | The account holder's own profile is set up.                          |
| Someone else (a child, partner or anyone you shop for) | Plus and Family, while there is room | The app asks for their name and creates a profile for them.          |
| Someone I've already added                             | Accounts that have added someone     | The user picks the person from their list and updates their profile. |

On the Free plan only "Me" is shown, and adding family members is presented as a reason to upgrade.

### Part 2: Foods to avoid

#### Question 2. Does **[name]** have any food allergies or intolerances, or foods they must avoid?

*Always asked.*

| Answer       | What happens                                                                         |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Yes          | The next questions ask which foods, and about each one.                              |
| No           | The app moves on to health conditions.                                               |
| I'm not sure | The user can pick anything they suspect. The app also suggests speaking to a doctor. |

#### Question 3. Which of these does **[name]** need to avoid?

*Asked if the answer to question 2 was Yes or I'm not sure.*

A list to pick from. The 14 allergens that food labels in the UK and EU must highlight are shown first:

*peanuts, tree nuts, milk, eggs, gluten, soy, fish, crustaceans (e.g. prawns), molluscs (e.g. mussels), sesame, mustard, celery, lupin, sulphites.*

More specific items (individual nuts, wheat as distinct from gluten, and so on) are available under "show more". Picking is optional here, because the next question covers anything missing.

#### Question 4. Is there anything else **[name]** needs to avoid that isn't in the list?

*Optional. Asked if the answer to question 2 was Yes or I'm not sure.*

The user types each food on its own, for example "kiwi" or "plantain" (up to 10).

| If the food is...                                                  | What happens                                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Something our list already knows, e.g. "prawns" or "celeriac"      | It is recorded as that allergen (Crustaceans, Celery), which also catches the other names it goes by. The user is told.                                             |
| Anything else                                                      | It is kept as typed. Every scan checks labels for that name straight away. The user is told it is checked by name only, so it may be missed under a different name. |
| A word on almost every label, e.g. "water" or "natural flavouring" | Refused, with a message asking for the food itself.                                                                                                                 |

Questions 5 to 8 are then asked separately for each food picked or typed, so nothing is skipped for any of them.

#### Question 5. What happens when [name] eats [food]?

*Asked for each food.*

| Answer                                        | Explained to the user as                                                                     | Recorded as                          |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| An allergic reaction                          | Hives, itching, swelling, vomiting or trouble breathing, usually within minutes to two hours | Allergy                              |
| Digestive trouble                             | Bloating, cramps or diarrhoea, often hours later                                             | Intolerance                          |
| Something else, or hard to pin down           | Headaches, skin flare-ups, feeling unwell                                                    | Sensitivity                          |
| No reaction; they avoid it for another reason | Diet, religion or personal preference                                                        | Dietary choice                       |
| I'm not sure                                  | We'll treat it as an allergy until you tell us more                                          | <b>Allergy</b> (the cautious choice) |

#### Question 6. How bad has [name]'s worst reaction to [food] been?

*Asked for each food, unless it is avoided by choice.*

| Answer           | Explained to the user as                                                                      | A product containing this food is shown as |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Severe           | Trouble breathing, throat or tongue swelling, fainting, or needed an EpiPen or emergency care | <b>High risk</b>                           |
| Needed treatment | Medicine or a doctor, but not an emergency                                                    | <b>High risk</b>                           |
| Mild             | Uncomfortable, but it passed on its own                                                       | Warning                                    |

| Answer                                  | Explained to the user as                             | A product containing this food is shown as |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| I'm not sure, or it hasn't happened yet | We'll treat it as severe until you tell us otherwise | <b>High risk</b> (treated as severe)       |

**Question 7. How strictly does [name] avoid [food]?**

*Only asked for foods avoided by choice.*

| Answer                                            | A product containing this food is shown as |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Strictly: any amount is a problem                 | <b>High risk</b>                           |
| Prefers to avoid it: a small amount is acceptable | Warning                                    |

**Question 8. Has a doctor confirmed that [name] reacts to [food]?**

*Optional. Not asked for foods avoided by choice.*

Yes / No / I don't know. This is saved for reference only and does not change any warning.

### Part 3: Health conditions

**Question 9. Does [name] have a health condition that affects what they eat?**

*Always asked.*

Yes / No.

**Question 10. Which of these apply to [name]?**

*Asked if the answer to question 9 was Yes.*

A list to pick from, such as diabetes, kidney disease or pregnancy. The app then points out ingredients to limit or avoid for those conditions when products are scanned.

**Question 11. When is [condition] expected to end?**

*Optional. Only asked for temporary conditions, such as pregnancy.*

A date; for a pregnancy, the due date. Two weeks after that date, the app asks the user whether the condition still applies. The advice never switches off by itself: advice that stays on too long is only inconvenient, while advice that switches off too early could tell someone a food is fine when it is not.

### Part 4: Anything else

**Question 12. Anything else you'd like to keep with [name]'s profile?**

*Optional.*

A short note, for example "carries an EpiPen" or "school packed lunch". Only the account holder can see it, and scans never read it.

### 3. The order of the questions

|    | Question                              | Shown when                                         |
|----|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Who are you setting up?               | Always (some answers depend on the plan)           |
| 2  | Any food allergies or foods to avoid? | Always                                             |
| 3  | Which foods from the list?            | Answer to 2 is Yes or I'm not sure                 |
| 4  | Any other foods? (typed in)           | Answer to 2 is Yes or I'm not sure (optional)      |
| 5  | What happens when they eat it?        | For each food picked or typed                      |
| 6  | How bad has the worst reaction been?  | For each food, unless avoided by choice            |
| 7  | How strictly is it avoided?           | For each food avoided by choice                    |
| 8  | Has a doctor confirmed it?            | For each food, unless avoided by choice (optional) |
| 9  | Any health condition affecting diet?  | Always                                             |
| 10 | Which conditions?                     | Answer to 9 is Yes                                 |
| 11 | When will it end?                     | For each temporary condition (optional)            |
| 12 | Anything else to note?                | Always (optional)                                  |

### 4. Safety decisions built into the questionnaire

These are deliberate choices. Each one leans towards warning people too much rather than too little.

- **"Not sure how bad" is treated as severe.** The app shows a strong "High risk" warning for severe or treated reactions, and only a milder "Warning" for mild ones. Someone who doesn't know how they would react, or has never reacted yet, is exactly the person who shouldn't get the milder warning. The user is told this was done and can change it later.
- **"Not sure what kind of reaction" is treated as an allergy,** for the same reason. Typed-in foods follow exactly the same rules.
- **Typed-in foods work straight away.** Nobody has to approve them first. A typed-in food can only make a result more cautious; it can never make a product look safer.
- **Answering again never removes anything.** If someone leaves out a food the second time, it is more likely a slip than a decision, and silently removing a safety setting could lead to a missed warning. Foods can only be removed deliberately, from the allergies screen. The app tells the user when earlier entries are still there.
- **Nothing is saved halfway.** If an answer is missing or contradicts another, or the person would go over their plan's limit, nothing is saved and the user is told what to fix.
- **Health conditions wait for a confirmed email address.** They are saved straight away but only take effect once the user has confirmed their email. The user is told this.

- **Lowering a plan's limit removes nobody.** People already on an account keep working; the account just can't add more.
- **Existing users aren't forced through it.** People who set up their allergies before the questionnaire existed are not made to answer it again.

## 5. What the user sees afterwards

After each person's answers are saved, the app shows the resulting list of foods and conditions, so the user can check and correct it. It also shows any of these messages that apply:

| Message                                           | Shown when                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Some reactions were recorded as severe            | The user answered "not sure" about how bad a reaction is               |
| Consider speaking to a doctor                     | The user wasn't sure whether the person has allergies at all           |
| Confirm your email to switch on health conditions | Conditions were added before the email address was confirmed           |
| We already know this food                         | A typed-in food was one on our list, so that allergen was used instead |
| Checked by name only                              | Typed-in foods were kept as typed; scans look for that name on labels  |
| Earlier entries are still on the profile          | The user answered again and left out foods recorded before             |

## 6. Keeping up with typed-in foods

With many users, people will type thousands of different foods. The team never has to approve them one by one:

- **Most never become custom entries.** Names we already know ("prawns", "shrimp", "celeriac", "egg") are switched to the right allergen as they are typed.
- **The team sees names, not entries.** Different spellings are grouped ("Prawns", "prawn"), each name is shown once with how many people added it, and names added by fewer than 5 people are hidden. The team works from the most-requested down.
- **One decision covers everyone.** When the team links a name to an allergen, everyone who typed it is upgraded at once, the scanner learns the name, and anyone typing it later gets the allergen straight away.
- **Private.** The team sees names and counts only, never who typed them.

## 7. What still needs sign-off

### Clinical review

The wording of the questions, how each answer is turned into a severity (section 2, questions 5 to 7, and the decisions in section 4), and the rule that typed-in foods are checked by name are clinical judgements. They were written with caution in mind but have not yet been reviewed by a qualified healthcare professional.

That review is the one outstanding item before this questionnaire should be relied on by the public.

### Changing the questions

The questions are managed centrally on the server, so wording can be changed without releasing a new version of the app. If a change alters what an answer means, the questionnaire's version number goes up, and people who answered the old version are invited to go through it again. This document describes version 2.